

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	CHC426 / CHC426P
Subject Title	Contemporary Chinese Art: A Global Perspective 中國當代藝術：全球性視角
Credit Value	3
Level	4
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	This course examines the history of contemporary art in China, beginning with the field's underground origins the 1970s and ending in the present. Through a chronological survey of major artists, artworks, exhibitions, and moments, this course provides a narrative of the development of Chinese art across a wide variety of media, including but not limited to painting, sculpture, video, installation, and performance art. The scope of the course is necessarily global, intertwining discussion of trends in contemporary art with other regions, especially but not limited to Hong Kong and other communities of Chinese artists. The course facilitates students in connecting the profound economic, social, and political changes of contemporary China to its art. The course concludes with a snapshot of the contemporary art industry's development in Hong Kong over the last decade. At the instructor's discretion, the course may also include class trips to museums or other art exhibition spaces in Hong Kong to complement lesson plans.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) Develop a basic historical understanding and aesthetic appreciation for major trends and artworks in the history of contemporary Chinese art; b) Perform formal visual analysis on a work of art; c) Articulate the relationship between major works of contemporary Chinese art and their historical, social, and economic contexts; d) Conduct independent research and develop an original interpretive argument regarding a self-selected work of art; e) Develop an understanding of the art and cultural landscape of greater China.

Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus (Note 2)	1) Introduction: What is Contemporary? What is China? What is Art? 2) Revolution and Reform: New Practices in Underground and Amateur Art Societies 3) The '80s and the Avant-Garde: The '85 New Wave 4) No U-Turn: The <i>China/Avant-Garde</i> Exhibition and Its Legacies 5) Within and Without China: Migration, Exile, and the Global Turn 6) Beyond Cynical Realism and Political Pop 7) Experimental Art and Institutions 8) Exhibitions of the New Millennium 9) Hong Kong Paradigms and Paradoxes 10) Olympic Ambitions: Between the Market and the Mainstream 11) Art Entrepot: A Snapshot of Art and Industry in Hong Kong Today
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	This course scaffolds student learning into a combination of lecture, classroom discussion, field trips, formal analysis assignments, and final paper writing. Students complete the assigned readings before attending lecture, view precirculated works of art, and prepare notes and questions on the materials. Lectures will provide key theoretical themes and concepts alongside their historical and social contexts. Additionally, lectures may devote time to developing the viewing, research, and writing skills necessary to complete the major assignments. Class visit to art exhibitions will complement the teaching plans. Students are expected to select a work of art within the purview of the course topic, conduct research on it, and deliver oral and written assignments focused on developing original interpretive arguments related to the artwork.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)					
			a	b	c	d	e	
	1. Reading and In Class Exercises	15%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	2. Formal Analysis	25%		✓	✓	✓	✓	
	3. Essay Proposal/Outline	25%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	4. Final Essay	35%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	Total	100 %						
Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: Reading and in class exercises allow students to demonstrate their ability to connect key historical themes and information from scholarly sources to the main questions being explored in the class. The formal analysis (#2) offers students the opportunity to develop their skills in conducting formal and interpretive analysis of a work of art. The essay proposal or outline prompts students to propose an original topic of research and perform initial research in posing a scholarly question regarding that artwork. The final essay (#4) allows students to demonstrate their synthesis of the course materials as well as their ability to conduct original research and present them in a written academic text.								
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:							
	▪ Lectures						26 Hrs.	
	▪ Tutorials						13 Hrs.	
	Other student study effort:							
	▪ Reading						46 Hrs.	
	▪ Writing						36 Hrs.	
	Total student study effort						121 Hrs.	
Reading List and References	- Andrews, Julia F., and Kuiyi Shen. <i>The Art of Modern China</i>. University of California Press, 2012. - Clarke, David. <i>Hong Kong Art: Culture and Decolonization</i>. Duke University Press, 2002. - DeBevoise, Jane. <i>Between State and Market: Chinese Contemporary Art in the Post-Mao Era</i>. Brill, 2014.							

	• Gao Minglu. <i>Total Modernity and the Avant-Garde in Twentieth-Century China</i>. MIT Press, 2011. • Li, Pi, ed. <i>Chinese Art Since 1970: The M+ Sigg Collection</i>. Thames and Hudson, 2021. • Lee, Jennifer Dorothy. <i>Anxiety Aesthetics: Maoist Legacies in China, 1978-1985</i>. University of California Press, 2024. • Lü Peng. <i>A History of Chinese Art in the 20th and 21st Century</i>. Palgrave Macmillan, 2025. • Munroe, Alexandra, Philip Tinari, and Hou Hanru, eds. <i>Art and China After 1989: Theater of the World</i>. Guggenheim, 2017. • Tan, Chang. <i>The Minjian and the Avant-Garde: Art of the Crowd in Contemporary China</i>. Cornell University Press, 2024. • Wang, Peggy. <i>The Future History of Contemporary Chinese Art</i>. University of Minnesota Press, 2021. • Wong, Winnie. <i>Van Gogh on Demand: China and the Readymade</i>. University of Chicago Press, 2014. • Wu Hung and Peggy Wang. <i>Contemporary Chinese Art: Primary Documents</i>. Thames and Hudson, 2014. • Wu Hung. <i>Contemporary Chinese Art</i>. Thames and Hudson, 2014.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

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